

- 3 A peg is fixed to the rim of a vertical turntable of radius r , rotating with a constant angular speed ω , as shown below.

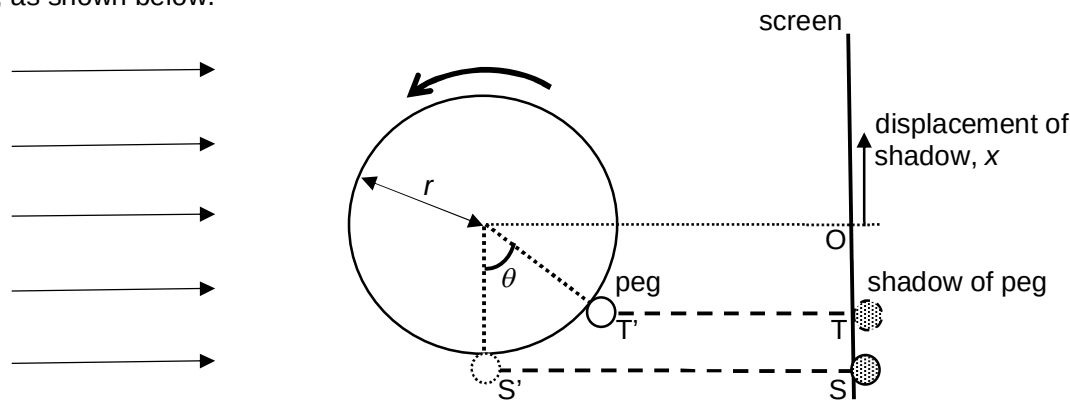


Fig. 3.1

A parallel beam of light is incident on the turntable such that the shadow of the peg is observed on the screen. Initially, the peg is at position S' and its shadow is at S . After time t , the peg moves through an angle of θ and it is positioned at T' while its shadow is at T . The displacement of the shadow, x , from O is shown in Fig. 3.1 where the upward direction is taken to be positive.

- (a) (i) Express the angular displacement of the peg, θ , in terms of ω and t . [1]

$$\theta = \omega t$$

- (ii) Write down an expression for the displacement, x , of the shadow on the screen in terms of ω , t and r . [1]

$$x = -r \cos \omega t$$

- (iii) Hence, prove that the shadow of the peg is moving in simple harmonic motion. Explain your working. [2]

Since velocity is the rate of change of displacement,

$$v = \frac{dx}{dt} = -\omega(-r \sin \omega t) = \omega r \sin \omega t$$

Since acceleration is the rate of change of velocity,

$$a = \frac{dv}{dt} = \omega(r \omega \cos \omega t) = \omega^2(r \cos \omega t) = -\omega^2(-r \cos \omega t) = -\omega^2 x$$

Since acceleration of the shadow a is directly proportional to its displacement x , and is in the opposite direction to displacement, $a = -\omega^2 x$ is the defining equation of a simple harmonic equation.

- (b) The turntable has a radius of 20.0 cm and angular speed of 3.5 rad s^{-1} . For the motion of the shadow on the screen,

- (i) calculate the acceleration of the shadow when the shadow is instantaneously at rest, [1]

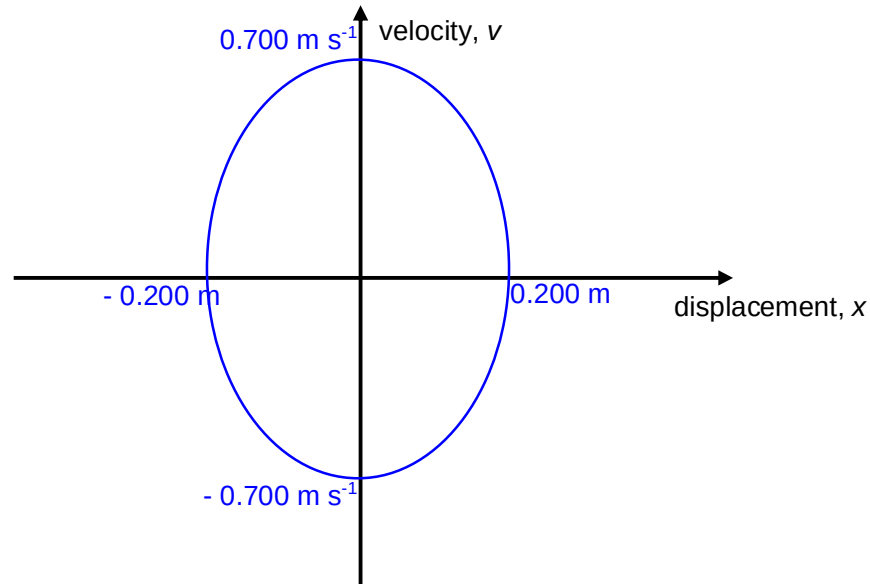
$$\begin{aligned} a &= -\omega^2 x \\ &= -(3.5)^2(0.200) \\ &= -2.45 \text{ m s}^{-2} \end{aligned}$$

- (ii) determine the velocity of the shadow as it passes through S, [1]

As the shadow passes through S, its amplitude position, it is instantaneously at rest.

$$\begin{aligned} v &= \pm \omega \sqrt{x^2 - x_o^2} \\ &= \pm \omega \sqrt{0.200^2 - 0.200^2} \\ &= 0.00 \text{ m s}^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

- (iii) sketch the variation of the velocity, v , of the shadow with its displacement, x .



$$\begin{aligned} v_{\max} &= \pm \omega \sqrt{x^2 - x_o^2} \\ &= \pm 3.5 \sqrt{0.200^2 - 0^2} \\ &= \pm 0.700 \text{ m s}^{-1} \end{aligned}$$

Elliptical shape with max v (y-intercept) = 0.700 m s^{-1} ;
max x (x-intercept) = 0.200 m